Rahul Rathod

AI ENGINEER

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SUMMARY

AI Engineer in the trading department at Flutter UK & Ireland, one of the largest online betting and gaming operators in the world. I build AI systems that traders use every day. That includes Request a Bet automation, odds boost automation and a new experimentation platform with data quality evals and RAG over experiment data. I also started and run the AI Accelerator, which helps traders, analysts and risk specialists use AI in their own work. I have been building software for over 16 years, much of it at scale in regulated, fast moving businesses.

CORE SKILLS

Languages TypeScript (Node.js), Python, SQL

Agents and LLMs Agent harnesses, tool use, multi agent orchestration, Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers and gateways, Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK, LangGraph, PydanticAI, context engineering, prompt caching, structured output, Anthropic Claude, OpenAI GPT, Google Gemini, open weight models (Llama, Qwen, DeepSeek), LoRA fine tuning

Recommendation, Search and Ranking Real time personalisation, two stage retrieval and learned ranking (LightGBM LambdaRank), hybrid search (BM25 and vector), knowledge graphs, embeddings, RAG over structured and unstructured data, vector databases (pgvector, OpenSearch, FAISS)

Evaluation and Experimentation Offline metrics (NDCG, recall, coverage), A/B and champion challenger testing, versioned eval sets with regression gates, data quality evals, LLM as judge, groundedness checks, guardrails, tracing with Langfuse and LangSmith

Cloud and Platform AWS (Lambda, ECS Fargate, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, Bedrock, SageMaker, CloudWatch), infrastructure as code with AWS CDK and Terraform, Docker, Kafka, Redis, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, CI/CD with GitHub Actions and Jenkins, OpenTelemetry, Grafana, latency budgets and load testing

Leadership AI adoption and training, technical leadership and mentoring, working across teams, stakeholder management

EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer, Automation Transformation and AI **Jun 2026 to Present**
Software Engineer **Jan 2023 to Jun 2026**
Flutter UK & Ireland (UKI Trading) *Leeds, UK*

- **Request a Bet automation.** Built the full pipeline that takes a bet request written by a customer and turns it into a priced offer ready to send. An LLM reads the request and breaks it into structured selections. Each leg is checked against a knowledge graph of events, markets and participants, odds are generated for the bet, and the reply is written in the brand voice and in line with safer gambling and compliance rules.
- **Odds boost automation.** Automated the boost workflow from start to finish with AI in each step, so traders no longer do it by hand and every boost goes through the same auditable process.
- **Experimentation at scale.** Working with the data science team to rethink how experiments run. We are redesigning the data flow so experiments can scale, adding evals that check the data is sound before anyone trusts a result, and putting RAG over the experiment data so stakeholders can ask questions in plain English and get answers grounded in the data.
- Started and lead the AI Accelerator for the department, which brings AI into the daily work of every trader and risk analyst and has driven adoption across the department.
- Own each AI system through its whole life, from finding the problem and building the prototype to evaluation, release, monitoring and improvement, with guardrails that fit a regulated business.
- Work with traders, product, risk and compliance to decide which AI work comes first, and ship tools that are reliable, observable and sensible on cost.

Assistant Consultant (via TCS) **Jan 2020 to Jan 2023**
Marks & Spencer *London, UK*

- Led delivery of Click & Collect and loyalty features across the UK and ROI, integrating account, payment and promotion APIs.
- Found and fixed a critical login regression that locked out thousands of users a day, restoring access and cutting support tickets.
- Worked with backend teams to consume personalisation feeds from Kafka, and with analytics so product decisions were based on data.

Assistant Consultant (via TCS) **May 2017 to Dec 2019**
Best Buy *Chennai, India*

- Delivered modules for product search, recommendations and dynamic pricing, integrated with Java microservices and caching layers.
- Made the apps more responsive by tuning API usage and background tasks, and more stable through monitoring and targeted fixes.

Technical Lead **May 2012 to Jul 2016**
Capgemini *Mumbai, India*

- Delivered enterprise mobile apps for clients including 3M, ING and Dako, with app store ratings averaging above 4.5.
- Managed distributed teams and the QA and release pipeline, and cut post release issues by 30% through performance and stability work.

Software Engineer **Apr 2011 to Jun 2012**
Persource *Ahmedabad, India*

- Built more than 15 apps for global clients including Yahoo and the Sundance Film Festival, owning each one from design to release.

Software Engineer **Sep 2010 to Apr 2011**
BYPT *Ahmedabad, India*

- Built live sports scoring apps with real time updates and a fast UI, recognised for usability and stability.

SELECTED AI PROJECTS

Projects I built in my own time. Full write ups are at raaulc.com/projects.

Real time game recommender. A two stage recommender (item kNN and SVD retrieval with a LightGBM LambdaRank ranker) that I took from a Python research prototype to a TypeScript service. It ranks 23% better on NDCG@10 than the best single model, tested on 3.15M plays from 53k players, and answers in 3.87 ms at p99. It updates as players play, applies cooldown, exclusion and diversity guardrails, explains every pick, and is tested to give the same results as the prototype. There is a live demo at raaulc.com/projects/realtime-recs. *TypeScript, Node, Python, LightGBM, SciPy*

AI paper radar. A daily pipeline that scores every new AI paper on arXiv for relevance and novelty with a typed decision model, ranks them and publishes the results with a full archive. It runs on its own every morning on GitHub Actions, with retries if a source fails. *Python, Jev, GitHub Actions, arXiv API*

Self RAG pipeline. A LangGraph workflow where the LLM grades the documents it retrieved, checks its answer for hallucinations and validates the answer before replying. *LangGraph, LangChain, Chroma, Groq, HuggingFace*

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electronics and Communication May 2009
Dharmsinh Desai University, Gujarat, India